increase in the past 50 years. Their sense of self as Indians derives not only from some heightened sense of patriotism, but also from the practical experience of being Indian passport holders. The expatriate experience, then, syncs with the everyday native life, making it far more likely that the words 'India' and 'Indian' are far more indigenised in Malayalam than is Bharat(ham).

In any case, B.R. Ambedkar settled the matter by starting Article 1 of the Constitution with the words "India, that is Bharat...." Personally, I feel that should satisfy all Indians, so that we can address the real problems faced by millions of Indians rather than waste time on semantic oneupmanship! ■

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Illustration by **TANMOY CHAKRABORTY**